Two Voice Agents — Design & Objection Handling

Rajiv Swain · Prompt Engineer Intern, Voice & Agentic AI · Sarvam AI + custom guardrail API

THE CORE DECISION: CONVERSATION IN SARVAM, LIMITS IN CODE

Caller
Speaks Hinglish, interrupts, changes language mid-sentence

↔

Sarvam AI
Speech recognition → LLM → voice. Barge-in, silence nudges, language switching

↔

My API
Facts, allowlists, date checks, tickets, post-call audit

↓

1 /on-start
Fills variables before the first sentence. The prompt holds no hardcoded rupee figure

2 /log-commitment
Amount must be on the allowlist. Date must be a real date. "Agle hafte" is refused

3 /escalate
Ticket plus a four digit reference. Selling stops

4 /webhook
Transcript → objections tagged, compliance findings, score

Why: the model negotiates, the API refuses to record anything unauthorised. A bad commitment is rejected with a correction the agent must speak, and the transcript is audited afterwards for anything said without approval.

BOT 1 — LOAN SETTLEMENT: AVOIDANCE VS HARDSHIP

OPEN
₹6,50,000
Dues stated, breakdown only if asked

→

AVOIDANCE
Repeated excuse
Salary delay, already paid, dispute

→

ROUTE
Avoidance or hardship?
Avoidance: return to date. Hardship: affordability

→

PRESSURE
Consequences
Recovery notice, arbitration, CIBIL

→

CLOSE
₹4,00,000 + date
Logged only if valid

Firm, not abusive: no police, no jail, no third-party disclosure. Avoidance gets a firm redirect to date and amount; genuine hardship gets an affordability conversation; a disputed payment goes to verification rather than repeated pressure.

BOT 2 — INSURANCE RENEWAL: THE PRICE LADDER

OPEN
₹20,000
IDV 9L → 8L, expiry 5 Nov

→

OBJECTION
"Zyada hai"
Only now is the concession unlocked

→

CONCEDE ONCE
₹15,000
Tied to confirming today

→

BELOW FLOOR
₹12,000 request
Rejected. Minimum authorised is ₹15,000

The brief asks for the **highest achievable value**, so the ladder is the design: the standard premium first, the authorised discount as a conditioned concession, and never below it.

OBJECTION HANDLING — SAME FOUR STEPS, BOTH BOTS

STEP	WHAT THE AGENT DOES	EXAMPLE
1 Acknowledge	One short clause, no agreement	"Samajh raha hoon, par yeh 8 mahine se pending hai."
2 Reframe	Change what is being compared	"Online quote ka IDV, cover aur deductible same hain? Pehle like-for-like compare karein."
3 One move	Concede once, or restate the floor	"Aaj confirm karein to 15,000." · "4 lakh se neeche approval nahi."
4 Ask	Demand a date or a decision	"Kaunsi date?" · "Link bhej doon?"

Loan — objections covered

- Salary delay · job loss · medical
- "Already paid" · amount dispute
- Second lender · how did you get this number
- Recording the call · EMI request · principal only

Insurance — objections covered

- Online cheaper · competitor quote
- IDV drop · no claim bonus
- Add-on questions · not needed
- Call later · already renewed

COMPLIANCE DECISIONS

RISK	HOW IT IS PREVENTED
Agent invents a number	Amounts validated in code; unauthorised figures rejected before the agent can confirm
Vague commitment	"Agle hafte", "month end", "agle shukravar" rejected until a real date is named
Threats	Legal consequences stated factually; no police, jail or public shaming in the prompt
Wrong person told the dues	Identity gate sits before any amount, IDV or premium
Add-on price invented	Explicit rule: no add-on figure unless it exists; offer a quote instead
Self-harm mention	Mandatory escalation with ticket, selling stops immediately
Silent or abusive caller	Nudge at 8s and 11s, then hang up; abusive caller escalated, never matched

Next: Postgres persistence behind the same store interface, and a review queue for calls scored below threshold.